

Mini Lesson Sample Script

Materials: Personal white board

1. Subtract fractions with like units using a number line.

Solve $5/6 - 3/6$ using the number line.



Answer: 5 sixths - 3 sixths = 2 sixths; $5/6 - 3/6 = 2/6$

T: Say this number sentence in unit form for me.

5 sixths minus 3 sixths.

S: 5 sixths minus 3 sixths.

T: We can subtract sixths the same way we subtract ones or apples. If I had 5 apples and took away 3 apples, how many would I have?

S: 2 apples.

T: So what's 5 sixths minus 3 sixths?

S: 2 sixths.

T: Let's show that on the number line. Our endpoints are 0 and 1. Partition the space between them into sixths.

S: (Partitions into 6 equal parts.)

T: Plot a point at $5/6$.

S: (Plots the point.)

	T: Now count back 3 sixths and draw an arrow to show the subtraction. S: 1 sixth, 2 sixths, 3 sixths. I landed on $\frac{2}{6}$. T: Write the subtraction sentence using fractions. S: $\frac{5}{6}$ minus $\frac{3}{6}$ equals $\frac{2}{6}$.
2. Add fractions with like units using a number line, and rename the sum greater than 1 as a mixed number using a number bond.	
Solve $\frac{5}{4} + \frac{2}{4}$ using the number line. Then use a number bond to rename the sum as a mixed number.  <i>Answer: 5 fourths + 2 fourths = 7 fourths; $\frac{5}{4} + \frac{2}{4} = \frac{7}{4}$; $\frac{7}{4} = 1$ and $\frac{3}{4}$</i>	T: Say this in unit form. S: 5 fourths plus 2 fourths. T: What's 5 fourths plus 2 fourths? S: 7 fourths. T: Let's show that on the number line. The endpoints are 0 and 2 this time. Why do you think we need to go to 2? S: Because 7 fourths is more than 1. T: Right. Partition each whole into fourths, then plot a point at $\frac{5}{4}$. S: (Partitions and plots $\frac{5}{4}$.)

T: Count forward 2 fourths and draw an arrow.

S: 1 fourth, 2 fourths. I'm at $\frac{7}{4}$.

T: Write the addition sentence using fractions.

S: $\frac{5}{4}$ plus $\frac{2}{4}$ equals $\frac{7}{4}$.

T: How many fourths are in 1 whole?

S: 4 fourths.

T: Draw a number bond. Put $\frac{7}{4}$ as the whole.

Pull out $\frac{4}{4}$ as one part. What's the other part?

S: $\frac{3}{4}$.

T: $\frac{4}{4}$ is the same as what number?

S: 1.

T: So $\frac{7}{4}$ is the same as 1 and $\frac{3}{4}$. We just renamed it as a mixed number. Are $\frac{7}{4}$ and 1 and $\frac{3}{4}$ equal?

S: Yes. They're the same amount, just written two different ways.